● MASTER OPERATIONAL BLUEPRINT • 2026-2027

JOEL NADAR — CYBERSECURITY & SecOps DOSSIER

Detailed Execution Manual: Deep Operational Specs, Exam Procedures, Lab Commands & Interview Strategy

CANDIDATE: **JOEL NADAR**
CORE LEVERAGE: **3 YRS ENTERPRISE & BIOMETRIC OPS**
DEGREE: **TYBMS (MANAGEMENT STUDIES)**

EXECUTIVE ORIENTATION — Why Your Specific Profile Outranks Pure Computer Science Freshers

1. THE TROUBLESHOOTING REFLEX — L1/L2 REALITY

You don't panic when an authentication service crashes. 95% of graduates freeze in front of a live Linux server dropping packets. You've handled real humans and high-throughput airport queues under strict SLA deadlines.

2. BIOMETRIC EDGE IAM DOMAIN — RARE SKILL

DigiYatra is India's flagship zero-trust facial recognition transit infrastructure. You already know how biometric hardware, cryptographic certificates, and transaction logs communicate between the edge and the cloud.

3. MANAGEMENT & AUDIT LOGIC — BMS ADVANTAGE

Cybersecurity is 50% technical defense and 50% risk governance, reporting, and SLA compliance. Your BMS degree gives you the executive business language that technical gatekeepers rarely possess.

PHASE 01 — Google Cybersecurity Completion, Experience Reframe & Credly Verification

Nov 1 – Dec 31, 2026

COURSERA EXAM MILESTONES & CREDLY BADGE — DEADLINE: DEC 20

- [ ] **Course 5 (Threats & Vulnerabilities):** Focus on CVSS v3.1 scoring, CVE lookups on NVD, and mapping threats to the MITRE ATT&CK matrix.
- [ ] **Course 6 (Detection & Response):** Complete the Chronicle SIEM and Suricata IDS packet inspection labs. Memorize the 6 NIST incident response phases.
- [ ] **Course 7 (Python Automation):** Complete the algorithm lab for parsing IP allowlists/denylists and reading system text logs using `with open()` and `re.findall()`.
- [ ] **Course 8 & Credly Claim:** Finish the final capstone security audit. Upon course completion, immediately claim and publish your verified badge on **Credly.com**.

EXACT RESUME BULLET POINTS (COPY-PASTE READY) — VERBATIM LANGUAGE

- [ ] **DigiYatra Bullet 1:** *"Administered real-time edge biometric authentication and Identity & Access Management (IAM) systems processing thousands of verifications per peak transit hour."*
- [ ] **DigiYatra Bullet 2:** *"Conducted high-volume incident triage and real-time transaction log audits to isolate network latency, sensor failures, and authentication timeouts."*
- [ ] **Production Support:** *"Maintained enterprise Linux server fleets and virtualized environments; executed structured SQL queries to audit database transaction integrity and monitored Jenkins CI/CD deployment gates."*
- [ ] **IT Infrastructure:** *"Governed Active Directory domain controllers, user access control policies (RBAC), and endpoint encryption (E2EE) protocols."*

🎓 **Degree Clearance Task:** Ensure all remaining TYBMS project submissions and ATKT exam paperwork are completed and signed off with your college before February 2027 so you have your provisional degree certificate ready for corporate background checks.

PHASE 02 (PART A) — TryHackMe SOC Level 1: Room-by-Room Checklist

Jan 1 – Jan 31, 2027

1. DEFENSIVE FRAMEWORKS — WEEK 1

- [ ] Room: `Pyramid of Pain` (TTPs vs Hashes)
- [ ] Room: `Cyber Kill Chain` (Lockheed Martin)
- [ ] Room: `MITRE ATT&CK` (Tactics vs Techniques)
- [ ] Room: `Unified Kill Chain`

2. NETWORK TRAFFIC LABS — WEEK 2

- [ ] Room: `Wireshark 101` & `Wireshark: Traffic Analysis`
- [ ] Room: `NetworkMiner` (Asset discovery)
- [ ] Room: `Snort` (Rule syntax and alerting)
- [ ] Room: `Zeek` (Live connection log parsing)

3. SIEM & INCIDENT RESPONSE — WEEKS 3 & 4

- [ ] Room: `Splunk Basics` & `Investigating with Splunk`
- [ ] Room: `Wazuh` (Rules, decoders, and alerts)
- [ ] Room: `Phishing Analysis Fundamentals`
- [ ] Room: `Memory Forensics with Volatility`

● TECHNICAL LABORATORY SPECIFICATIONS

HANDS-ON LABS, WAZUH SIEM & PCAP FORENSICS

Exact Hardware Specs, Linux Commands, Attack Scripts, and Packet Filtering Cheat-Sheets

EXECUTION TIMEFRAME: **JAN 15 - FEB 28, 2027**
ESTIMATED LAB COST: **₹0 (100% FREE & OPEN SOURCE)**

LAB ENVIRONMENT — Deploying Your Private Wazuh SIEM Detection Lab in VirtualBox

Zero-Cost Setup

VIRTUAL MACHINE HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS — SPECS

- [ ] **Hypervisor:** Oracle VM VirtualBox 7.x (or VMware Workstation Player).
- [ ] **SIEM Server OS:** Ubuntu Server 22.04 LTS (allocate 4GB RAM, 2 vCPUs, 30GB VDI disk).
- [ ] **Network Adapter:** Set to `Bridged Adapter` so your host PC can reach the Wazuh dashboard at `https://<VM_IP>`.
- [ ] **Target Endpoint OS:** Windows 10/11 or Ubuntu Desktop (runs Wazuh Agent).

SINGLE-LINE WAZUH INSTALLATION SCRIPT — SHELL EXECUTION

Execute inside Ubuntu Server terminal to install Manager, Indexer, and Dashboard:

```
curl -sO https://packages.wazuh.com/4.8/wazuh-install.sh &&
sudo bash ./wazuh-install.sh -a
```

Save the generated admin password printed in the terminal. Open a browser on your main PC, visit `https://<UBUNTU_IP>`, and log in with user `admin`.

ATTACK SIMULATION: SIMULATING SSH BRUTE-FORCE WITH HYDRA — OFFENSIVE TELEMETRY

1. Launch brute-force from your host PC (WSL / Kali VM):

```
hydra -l testuser -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt
ssh://<TARGET_IP> -t 4
```

2. Expected Wazuh Security Alerts Triggered in Dashboard:

- [ ] **Rule ID 5710:** `sshd: Attempt to login using a non-existent user` (Level 5)
- [ ] **Rule ID 5712:** `sshd: brute force trying to get access to the system` (Level 10)

NETWORK FORENSICS — Wireshark Malicious Packet Capture (PCAP) Analysis Protocols

Malware-Traffic-Analysis.net

1. STEP-BY-STEP TRIAGE — WORKFLOW

- [ ] **Step 1:** Go to `Statistics → Protocol Hierarchy` to identify abnormal protocols.
- [ ] **Step 2:** Go to `Statistics → Conversations → IPv4` to find top bandwidth consumers.
- [ ] **Step 3:** Export suspicious binaries via `File -> Export Objects → HTTP`.
- [ ] **Step 4:** Check extracted file hashes on VirusTotal and Hybrid-Analysis.

2. CRITICAL DISPLAY FILTERS — SYNTAX CHEAT-SHEET

- [ ] `http.request.method == "POST"` (Exfiltration)
- [ ] `dns.flags.response == 0 and dns.qry.name contains "malicious"`
- [ ] `tcp.flags.syn == 1 and tcp.flags.ack == 0` (Port Scans)
- [ ] `kerberos.CNameString contains "admin"`

3. LETSDEFEND.IO PRACTICE — SOC SIMULATOR

- [ ] Sign up for the free tier on **LetsDefend.io**.
- [ ] Triage alert: `SOC104 - Malware Detected` (Contain endpoint).
- [ ] Triage alert: `SOC108 - Phishing Mail Detected` (Inspect headers).
- [ ] Triage alert: `SOC142 - SSH Brute Force` (Block attacker IP).

Portfolio Artifact Generation: Take clean, uncropped screenshots of your Wireshark filters and Wazuh alert graphs during these labs. These exact screenshots form the visual backbone of your Phase 4 SecOps portfolio write-ups.

● EXAMINATION AUTHORITY & MECHANICS

COMPTIA SECURITY+ (SY0-701) MASTER GUIDE

Complete Pearson VUE Test Center Logistics, Voucher Discount Hacks, PBQ Exam Tactics & Scoring

EXAM TARGET: **MARCH 2027**
EXAM PASS SCORE: **750 / 900**
GLOBAL RECOGNITION: **DoD 8570 / 8140 APPROVED**

EXAM ATTENDANCE — Pearson VUE In-Person Test Center Logistics (Mumbai Region)

home.pearsonvue.com/comptia

IN-PERSON TESTING SITES (WHY THIS IS NON-NEGOTIABLE) — CRUCIAL ADVICE

- [ ] **Why Avoid Online (OnVUE):** Online proctors will instantly revoke and fail your $390 exam with zero refund if your home Wi-Fi drops for 4 seconds, if you read questions aloud, or if ambient street noise triggers their mic.
- [ ] **Authorized Mumbai Test Centers:** Pearson VUE has certified testing labs across Andheri East, Dadar West, Vashi (Navi Mumbai), and Thane (e.g., Seed Infotech, NIIT, or dedicated Pearson Professional Centers).
- [ ] **Controlled Environment:** The test center provides a soundproof cubicle, high-speed fiber connection, backup generators, noise-canceling headphones, and physical scratch paper.

MANDATORY TWO-ID GOVERNMENT IDENTIFICATION POLICY — CHECK BEFORE LEAVING

- [ ] **Primary ID (Must have photo + signature):** Valid Passport, Driver's License, or original PAN Card. (Name on ID must match Pearson VUE account *letter-for-letter*).
- [ ] **Secondary ID (Must have signature or name):** Credit/Debit card with signature strip signed, or original Aadhaar Card.
- [ ] **Biometric Verification at Center:** They will take a digital photo of your face and a digital palm vein scan before unlocking your testing terminal.
- [ ] **Locker Storage:** All phones, smartwatches, wallets, and keys must be locked in their secure locker outside the testing room.

HOW TO SAVE ~₹12,000+ ON THE EXAM VOUCHER — FINANCIAL OPTIMIZATION

1. CompTIA Academic Store Hack: Because you are enrolled in TYBMS, you are eligible for the **CompTIA Academic Marketplace** (`academic-store.comptia.org`). Using college ID proof or student verification drops the exam voucher cost from ~$404 down to ~$254 (saving ~₹12,500).

2. Partner Promo Discounts: If academic verification is unavailable, purchase through Professor Messer (`professormesser.com`) or Jason Dion's training portal for an immediate 10% promo discount voucher code.

EXAM DAY PROTOCOL — The 90-Minute Exam Architecture & The "PBQ Skip" Strategy

Exam Code: SY0-701

1. THE "PBQ SKIP" RULE — CRUCIAL TIME HACK

- [ ] Questions 1 to 4 are always **Performance-Based Questions (PBQs)** (interactive simulations).
- [ ] **DO NOT DO THEM FIRST.** They cause panic and drain 30 minutes of time.
- [ ] Click "Flag for Review" on Questions 1–4 immediately and jump straight to Question 5 (Multiple Choice).

2. PACING MILESTONES — MINUTE BREAKDOWN

- [ ] **00m – 55m:** Complete all ~80 multiple choice questions (approx 40 seconds per question).
- [ ] **55m – 80m:** Return to the 3–4 flagged PBQs with a calm mind and 25 full minutes remaining.
- [ ] **80m – 90m:** Review flagged multiple choice questions. Never leave an answer blank.

3. INSTANT PASS/FAIL RESULTS — SCORE REVEAL

- [ ] At the 90-minute mark, a mandatory 2-minute demographic survey will appear.
- [ ] Click through the survey questions. The very next screen displays your score (e.g., `792 / 900 - PASS`).
- [ ] Walk to the front desk; the proctor hands you an official embossed printed score report.

🎯 **Study Benchmark:** Do not book your test date until you score **85%+ on Jason Dion's Practice Exams 1 through 6** on Udemy. Dion's tests are deliberately harder than the real CompTIA exam; when you clear his benchmarks, you are guaranteed to pass the real test.

● PLACEMENT STRATEGY & EMPLOYMENT EXECUTION

SECOPS DOSSIER & JOB MARKET TRANSITION

Publishing Portfolio Proof, Employer Targeting, Shift Allowance Realities & Winning Technical Scripts

MARKET LAUNCH: **APRIL - MAY 2027**
TARGET ROLES: **TIER 1 / TIER 2 SOC ANALYST**
LOCATION: **MUMBAI / REMOTE HYBRID**

PHASE 04 Publishing the 3 High-Impact SecOps Portfolio Write-Ups

April 2027

PROJECT 1: WAZUH SIEM LAB — DETECTION OPS

- [ ] Title: *"Enterprise Threat Detection Lab: Wazuh SIEM Deployment & SSH Brute-Force Telemetry"*
- [ ] Include architecture diagram: Host VM -> VirtualBox NAT -> Wazuh Indexer -> Elastic Dashboard.
- [ ] Show screenshot of custom rule triggering on Hydra attacks + automated firewall IP block script.

PROJECT 2: PCAP FORENSICS — NETWORK ANALYSIS

- [ ] Title: *"Malware Traffic Forensics: Tracing Emotet/Qakbot C2 Callbacks in Wireshark"*
- [ ] Step-by-step investigation of malicious DNS requests and suspicious SSL handshake certificates.
- [ ] Extraction of payload hashes and mapping techniques to MITRE ATT&CK ID `T1071.001`.

PROJECT 3: BIOMETRIC IAM — YOUR SECRET WEAPON

- [ ] Title: *"Hardening Edge Biometric Transit: Zero-Trust IAM Architecture & Threat Modeling"*
- [ ] Deconstruct risk vectors: sensor spoofing, unencrypted telemetry interception, physical tampering.
- [ ] Propose defense: mTLS mutual authentication, hardware TPM keys, and audit log hashing.

PHASE 05 The Hiring Engine: Portals, Keywords, MSSPs & 24/7 Shift Reality

May 2027 Onwards

PORTALS, SEARCH KEYWORDS & TARGET EMPLOYERS — HIRING RADAR

- [ ] **Exact Job Titles on Naukri & LinkedIn:** `L1 SOC Analyst`, `Security Operations Center Trainee`, `Cyber Security Monitoring Analyst`, `Junior Incident Responder`, `IAM Operations Engineer`.
- [ ] **Prime MSSPs in Mumbai / Pune:** Wipro Cyber, TCS Cyber Defense Centers, Sify Technologies, Tech Mahindra, Infosys Cyber, Paladion (Atos), CyberProof, Network Intelligence (NII).
- [ ] **Banking & Fintech Captives:** HDFC Bank SOC (Kanjurmarg), ICICI Bank Cyber Cell, Axis Bank, NPCI, Razorpay, PhonePe.
- [ ] **Resume "Immediate Joiner" Tactic:** Set your profile status on Naukri to *"Serving Notice Period / Immediate Joiner"* when 30 days out to trigger 5× recruiter algorithm reach.

THE 24/7 ROTATIONAL SHIFT ADVANTAGE (BONUS SALARY) — COMPENSATION REALITY

- [ ] **SOC Shift Structure:** Almost all enterprise SOCs run 24/7/365 shifts: Morning (7 AM – 3 PM), Evening (3 PM – 11 PM), and Night (11 PM – 7 AM) with 2 days off rotational.
- [ ] **Shift Allowance (Extra Cash):** Most enterprises pay an additional **₹8,000 to ₹16,000 per month** in tax-free night-shift allowances on top of your base salary.
- [ ] **Why Your Past Wins:** Many fresh graduates quit after 2 months because they can't handle night shifts. Your 3 years of production support proves you already have the endurance for shift operations.

VERBATIM TECHNICAL INTERVIEW SCRIPTS — EXECUTIVE DELIVERY

Interviewer: "Why are you switching from Production Support to Cybersecurity?"
"I'm not switching from scratch; I'm advancing. Over the last 3 years, I've supported enterprise Linux servers, database queries, and DigiYatra's high-throughput biometric authentication infrastructure. I already know how production systems operate, fail, and log anomalies. By adding CompTIA Security+ and practical SIEM detection engineering to that foundation, I can protect systems rather than just keeping them running."

Interviewer: "Walk me through how you investigate a suspicious alert."
"I follow the NIST incident response model. First, I verify whether it's a true or false positive by checking correlated telemetry in the SIEM—inspecting timestamps, source IPs, and Windows Event IDs like 4625. If confirmed malicious, I identify the affected asset, isolate the host from the network to contain lateral spread, extract the file hashes to query threat intel databases, terminate the process, and write a custom detection rule so it never bypasses defenses again."